RMIT University Vietnam
BUSM2580 – Integrated Perspectives on Business Problems

Hope Box
Good Food. Great Cause.

MOVE FOR HOPE

RUNNING TOWARD A FUTURE OF DIGNITY & INDEPENDENCE



ASSIGNMENT 3

Business Solution Design Report

Industry Partner (case study):
HopeBox Vietnam







TUTORIAL LECTURER
Hung Nguyen

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Purpose and Background

This report examines HopeBox Vietnam, a social enterprise supporting women survivors of gender-based violence (GBV) through vocational training, trauma-informed support, and employment pathways. Despite its strong ESG alignment and meaningful social impact, HopeBox faces a major challenge related to unstable revenue streams caused by heavily seasonal corporate engagement patterns. Corporate partnerships and B2B procurement activities remain concentrated around festive periods such as Tet, Mid-Autumn Festival, and Christmas, creating cyclical income fluctuations that threaten year-round operational sustainability. Therefore, this report evaluates HopeBox's alignment with SDG 5, SDG 8, and SDG 10 while proposing strategic solutions to strengthen non-seasonal corporate engagement and long-term financial resilience.

Methodology

The report applies the Design Thinking framework to investigate HopeBox's revenue instability challenge from a stakeholder-centered perspective. Analytical tools including stakeholder analysis, persona development, empathy mapping, journey mapping, brainstorming, affinity diagramming, and the 5 Whys framework were used to identify underlying causes contributing to seasonal engagement patterns. Corporate B2B partners were identified as the key stakeholder group due to their direct influence on revenue continuity and partnership sustainability. Proposed solutions were then evaluated based on desirability, feasibility, and viability.

Findings

The findings reveal that HopeBox's revenue instability is not caused by a lack of stakeholder interest, but by the absence of structured, continuous corporate engagement mechanisms beyond seasonal campaigns. Corporate partners increasingly seek measurable ESG outcomes, authentic social impact, and long-term collaboration opportunities; however, HopeBox's current engagement model remains largely transactional, and campaign driven. Three major issues were identified: limited non-seasonal engagement opportunities, insufficient year-round impact visibility, and the absence of recurring partnership structures. The analysis identified the HopeBox

Mid-Year Impact Gala as the most strategically balanced solution due to its ability to strengthen ESG visibility, stakeholder engagement, and recurring corporate interaction.

Conclusion

The report concludes that HopeBox possesses strong social credibility, ESG relevance, and stakeholder goodwill; however, its current seasonal engagement structure limits long-term financial resilience and operational stability. Strengthening year-round B2B relationship management is therefore essential for sustaining survivor support programs and expanding HopeBox's long-term social impact. Developing structured, mission-aligned corporate engagement pathways can help reduce revenue volatility while encouraging deeper partnership commitment and continuous ESG collaboration.

Recommendations

To strengthen financial sustainability and reduce dependence on seasonal revenue cycles, HopeBox should implement the Mid-Year Impact Gala as an annual flagship ESG engagement event targeting corporate partners during low-engagement periods. The organization should further develop recurring partnership structures such as annual sponsorship programs and continuous corporate touchpoints to improve relationship continuity beyond festive campaigns. In parallel, HopeBox should enhance year-round impact visibility through consistent storytelling, digital engagement, and public corporate recognition strategies to support ongoing stakeholder trust and sponsor retention. Collectively, these initiatives can strengthen corporate engagement continuity, improve partnership sustainability, and support HopeBox's long-term mission of empowering survivors of gender-based violence through sustainable social enterprise operations.

ABBREVIATION LIST

- ACNC — Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission
- AI — Artificial Intelligence
- B2B — Business-to-Business
- CSR — Corporate Social Responsibility
- ESG — Environmental, Social and Governance
- GBV — Gender-Based Violence
- GSO — General Statistics Office
- HMW — How Might We
- MOLISA — Ministry of Labour, Invalids and Social Affairs
- NGO — Non-Governmental Organization
- SDGs — Sustainable Development Goals
- UNFPA — United Nations Population Fund
- WHO — World Health Organization

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I. INTRODUCTION

Amid growing attention toward gender equality, corporate sustainability, and social inclusion in Vietnam, social enterprises are increasingly expected to deliver both measurable social impact and long-term financial sustainability. Operating within this landscape, HopeBox Vietnam supports survivors of gender-based violence (GBV) through a hybrid social enterprise model that combines vocational empowerment with commercial hospitality activities (Dung and Kevin 2024; HopeBox n.d.). However, despite its growing social relevance and ESG alignment, HopeBox continues to face a significant operational challenge related to unstable revenue streams caused by heavily seasonal corporate engagement patterns.

Corporate engagement and B2B purchasing activities remain heavily concentrated around festive periods such as Tet, Mid-Autumn Festival, and Christmas, creating cyclical income patterns throughout the year. This creates financial pressure because HopeBox's survivor support programs, accommodation services, vocational training, and operational activities require continuous year-round funding. In addition, growing corporate expectations surrounding measurable ESG outcomes and long-term partnership value are increasing pressure on social enterprises to maintain more consistent stakeholder engagement and impact visibility.

Therefore, this report examines HopeBox's revenue instability challenge through the application of the Design Thinking framework. The report analyzes HopeBox's business context, stakeholder relationships, and the underlying causes contributing to seasonal corporate engagement patterns. More importantly, it proposes strategic solutions designed to strengthen non-seasonal corporate engagement, improve long-term partnership sustainability, and support HopeBox's year-round financial resilience and social impact delivery.

II. ANALYSIS

1. HopeBox's Background

HopeBox is a Vietnamese social enterprise established in 2018, operating at the intersection of gender-based violence (GBV) prevention, women's economic empowerment, and community development (Dung and Kevin 2024; HopeBox n.d.). The organization operates under the fundamental ethos of 'Good food. Great cause.'—a philosophy that serves as the strategic bridge between its commercial activities and social mission (HopeBox n.d.). Founded in response to the widespread prevalence of GBV across Vietnam, the organization initially operated as a small e-commerce platform before evolving into a multifaceted social enterprise. HopeBox formally registered with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission in 2021, reflecting its commitment to governance accountability and international standards of transparency (Dung and Kevin 2024).

The organization's model is grounded in the recognition that the GBV constitutes both a human rights crisis and a barrier to sustainable economic development. According to a National Study on Violence against Women in Vietnam (2019), 63% of Vietnamese women have experienced some form of violence from their husbands, with 32% reporting such incidents within the preceding 12 months, and 90% of them did not seek to report the abuse at the time (MOLISA, GSO, UNFPA 2020). These figures position Vietnam among the countries with the highest documented rates of intimate partner violence in Southeast Asia (WHO 2021), underscoring the urgency of the support systems HopeBox provides.

To address this crisis, the organization has demonstrated a measurable Scale of Impact, providing direct support to over 60 survivors through its holistic transition program. In 2022 alone, HopeBox reached a significant operational milestone by employing 25 women in its six-month intensive vocational program. This progress proves that high-quality culinary products can serve as a successful vehicle for deep social rehabilitation and long-term economic agency (Dung and Kevin 2024; Huong Dang 2025). Its holistic model combines work-based therapy, trauma healing, and hospitality training—successfully transforms commercial culinary activities into a sustainable pathway for women to escape the cycle of violence.

2. HopeBox's Business Context

2.1 Vision, Mission and Values

HopeBox's vision is to become 'a pioneer social enterprise in Vietnam that leaves no women or children behind because of gender-based violence' (Dung and Kevin 2024; Hopebox n.d.). This statement reflects its commitment to systemic social change in how Vietnamese society responds to GBV.

The organization's mission is to empower survivors by providing a safe living environment, pathways to income generation, and access to education, thereby enabling women to live free from sexual abuse and violence, and to raise their children in non-violent environments (Dung and Kevin 2024). Operationally, this mission is enacted through a transition model that combines hospitality-sector skills training, job search skills, career development, trauma healing and work-based therapy.

HopeBox's RESPECT values — Respect, Empower, Skills, Partnership, Employment, Compassion and Teamwork, this further position the organization as a survivor-centered social enterprise grounded in dignity, empowerment and long-term independence (Dung and Kevin 2024; HopeBox n.d.). This values framework aligns directly with Servant Leadership theory, which posits that sustainable organizational impact is achieved by prioritizing the growth and wellbeing of those they serve (Greenleaf 2002).

2.2 Business Model

The Business Model Canvas demonstrates that HopeBox operates as a hybrid social enterprise, where commercial activities and social impact are mutually reinforcing (Boni et al. 2021).

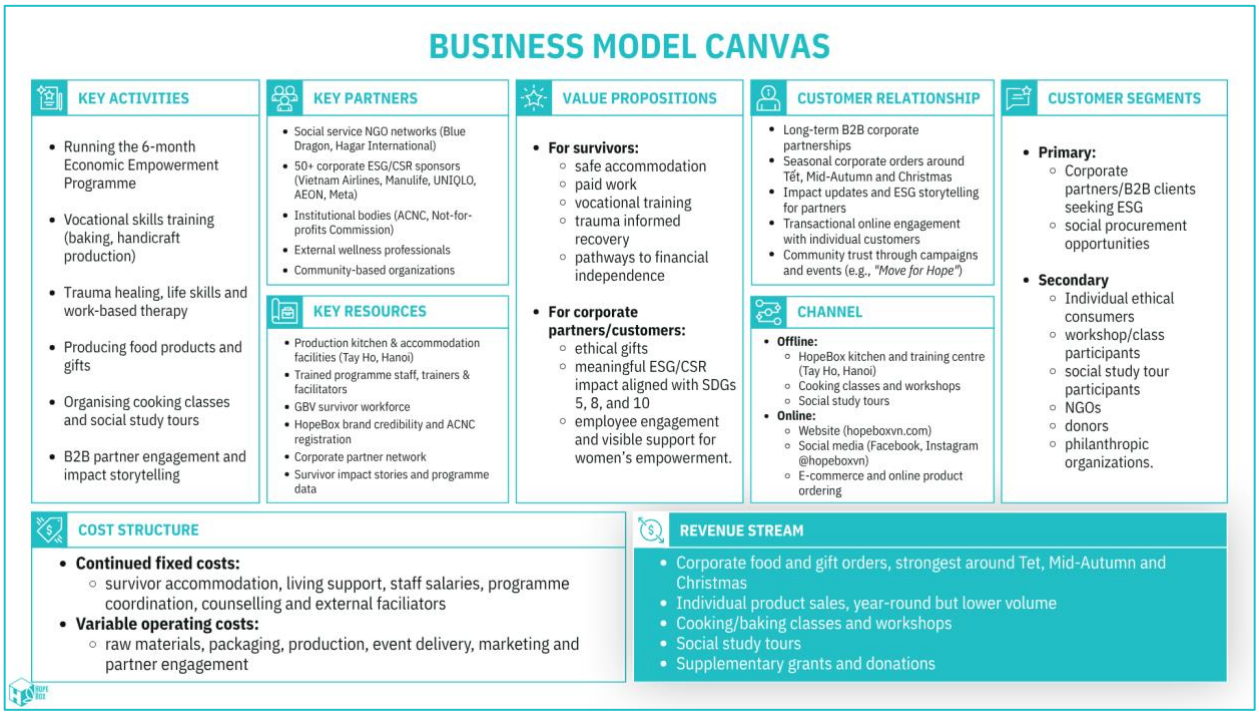


Figure 1: *HopeBox's Business Model*

As shown in **Figure 1,** HopeBox's value proposition serves two groups: Survivors receive safe accommodation, paid work, vocational training and trauma-informed support, while corporate partners receive ethical products, ESG/CSR value and visible support for women's empowerment. Revenue from corporate gifting, product sales, workshops and social study tours supports core activities such as the six-month Economic Empowerment Program, trauma healing and work-based therapy. However, the canvas also exposes a hybrid enterprise paradox (Battilana and Lee 2020). HopeBox's cost structure includes continuous fixed costs such as accommodation, staff salaries and program coordination, while its strongest revenue stream depends heavily on seasonal corporate food and gift orders around Tet, Mid-Autumn and Christmas. This mismatch between year-round support needs and seasonal cash inflows directly informs the challenge analysis below.

2.3 Business Environment

The SWOT analysis was used to assess HopeBox's internal strengths and weaknesses alongside external opportunities and threats affecting its revenue sustainability.

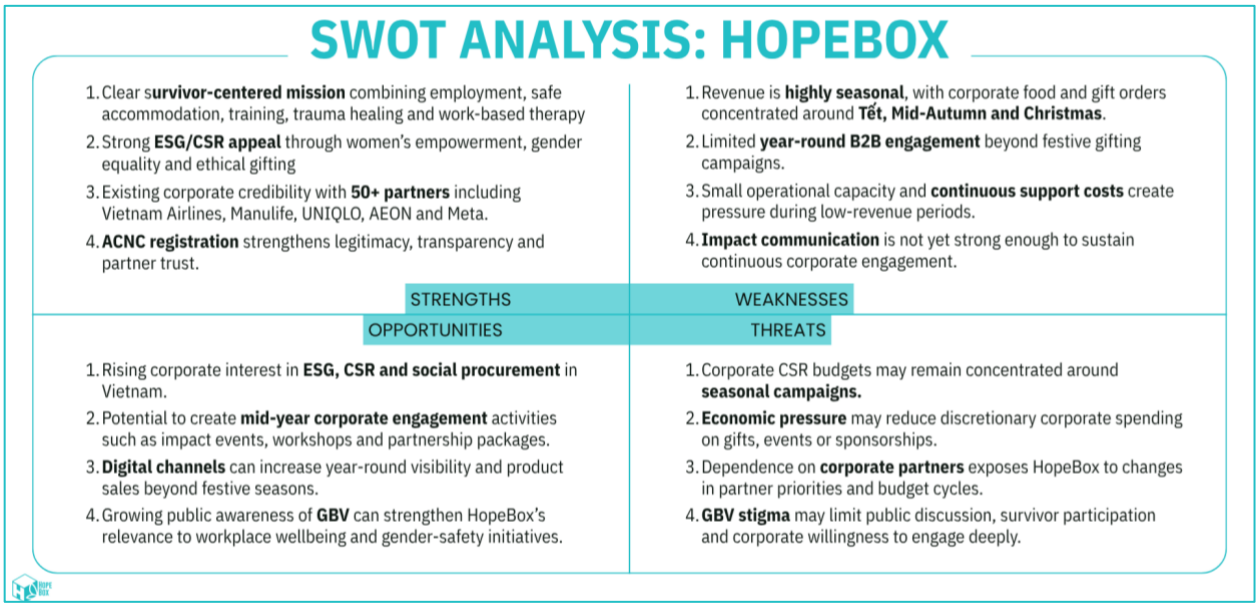


Figure 2: *HopeBox SWOT summary (Gürel and Tat 2017)*

The SWOT analysis shows that HopeBox operates in a business environment with strong social impact potential but clear financial vulnerability. Internally, HopeBox benefits from a survivor-centered mission, strong ESG/CSR alignment and corporate credibility through partnerships with organizations such as Vietnam Airlines, UNIQLO, AEON and Meta. These strengths position HopeBox favorably within Vietnam's growing sustainability landscape, as 80% of consumers are willing to pay more for sustainably produced or ethically sourced products (PwC 2024). However, HopeBox remains exposed to seasonal revenue concentration, limited year-round B2B engagement and continuous operating costs.

Externally, rising corporate interest in workplace wellbeing, ESG initiatives and social impact creates opportunities for mid-year B2B engagement. Vietnam's digital economy is also estimated at USD 39 billion in 2025, supporting opportunities for year-round digital visibility and online customer engagement (Google et al. 2025). Nevertheless, economic uncertainty, seasonal CSR spending behavior and dependence on corporate partners continue to threaten revenue stability. Therefore, the SWOT reinforces the need for stronger non-seasonal corporate engagement beyond festive campaigns. Additional macro-environmental analysis is provided in ***Appendix A***.

3. United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (UN SDGs)

As shown in **Figure 3**, HopeBox contributes to SDG 5 by supporting women survivors of gender-based violence through safe accommodation, trauma-informed support and pathways to independence. This is directly relevant because GBV limits women's safety, autonomy and ability to participate fully in society. Second, HopeBox supports SDG 8 by providing paid work, hospitality training, employability skills and career development, helping survivors move toward financial independence and more stable employment. Third, HopeBox contributes to SDG 10 by reducing social and economic exclusion faced by GBV survivors, who often experience stigma, financial dependence and limited access to support systems.

These SDGs are directly connected to HopeBox's selected challenge of unstable revenue streams. Without more stable year-round revenue, HopeBox may struggle to sustain the employment, training and recovery support required to deliver long-term impact. Therefore, strengthening non-seasonal corporate engagement is not only a financial issue, but also a sustainability issue: it enables HopeBox to maintain continuous support for survivors while advancing gender equality, decent work and reduced inequalities.



Figure 3: *UN SDGs align with HopeBox's mission and vision (United Nations 2015)*

4. Challenges Overview

HopeBox's primary operational challenges lies in **revenue instability**, which threatens both its long-term financial sustainability and social mission (Dung and Kevin 2024). The organization currently generates income through food and gift products, cooking and baking classes, and social study tours. However, corporate procurement and B2B demand remain heavily concentrated around festive periods such as Tet, Mid-Autumn Festival, and Christmas, creating uneven revenue patterns throughout the year.

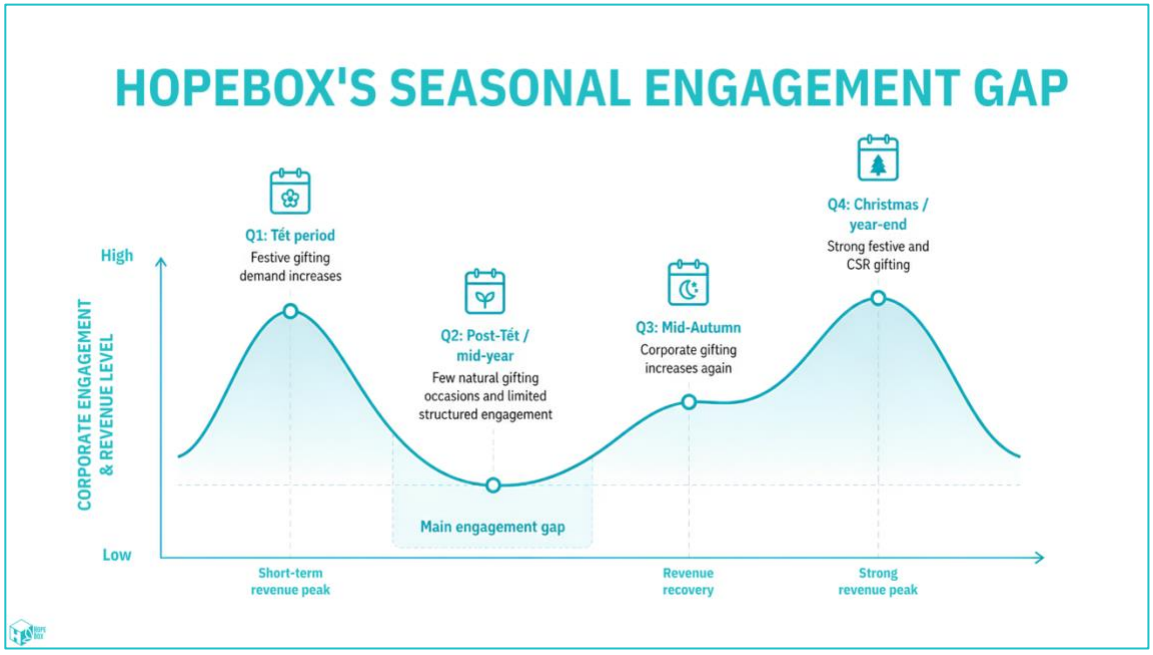


Figure 4: *HopeBox's Seasonal B2B Engagement Gap*

As illustrated in **Figure 4**, HopeBox experiences short-term revenue peaks during major festive periods, followed by a significant decline in engagement during the post-Tet and mid-year period. This trend reveals a critical internal–external mismatch. **Internally**, HopeBox operates a high-cost social enterprise model in which survivor accommodation, program coordination, training, and trauma-informed support require continuous year-round resources. **Externally**, corporate engagement is largely influenced by seasonal gifting behavior and short-term CSR campaign cycles rather than ongoing partnerships. Consequently, the gap between continuous operational costs and uneven revenue generation creates financial pressure during low-engagement periods. ***Therefore, the figure highlights the strategic need for HopeBox to strengthen non-seasonal corporate engagement to support more stable year-round revenue.***

5. Stakeholder Analysis

Based on the identified revenue instability challenge, key stakeholders are categorized and presented in **Figure 5**.



Figure 5: *Key Stakeholders based on identified challenge*

Internally, revenue instability impacts several levels of the organization. **HopeBox management** oversees long-term organizational sustainability, partnership development, and financial continuity. **Program coordinators** manage the daily delivery of survivor support, vocational training, and programme operations. **Survivor trainees** are also highly dependent on organization resources, as accommodation, training, and trauma-informed support require stable funding.

Externally, **corporate B2B partners** play a central role in HopeBox's revenue generation through festive gifting campaigns and CSR initiatives. **Donors and sponsors** contribute supplementary financial support and therefore remain concerned with organizational transparency and long-term impact outcomes. In addition, **NGOs and referral partners** such as Blue Dragon and Hagar support survivor referrals and community outreach, while customers and workshop participants contribute through product purchases, culinary classes, and social study tours (HopeBox n.d.).

5.1 Key Stakeholder Prioritization

Figure 6 presents a stakeholder power–interest matrix used to evaluate stakeholder influence and involvement in HopeBox's revenue instability challenge.

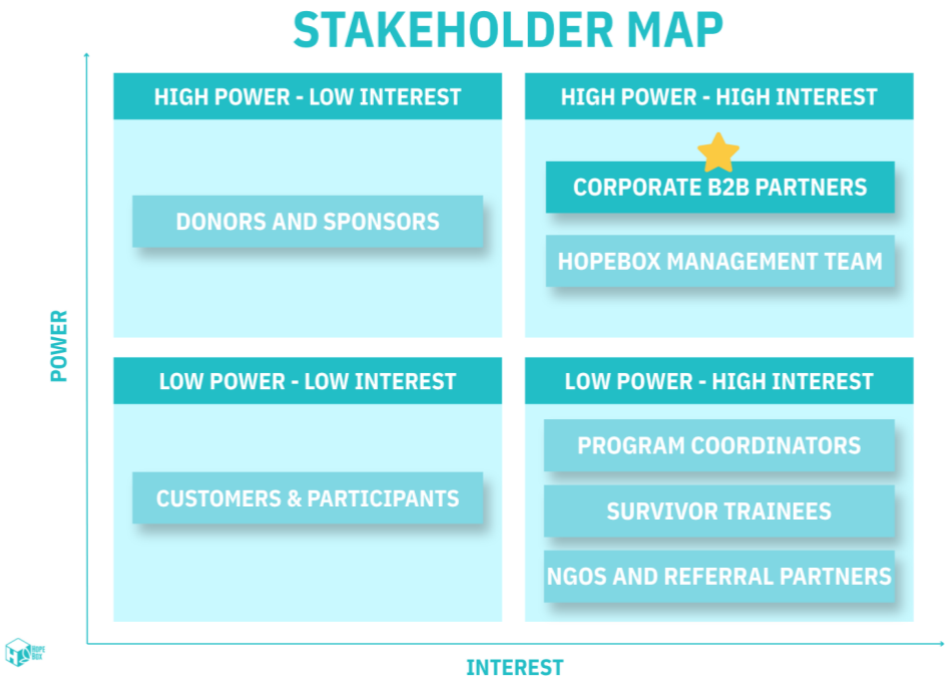


Figure 6: *Stakeholders Map (Bryson 2004)*

Stakeholders positioned within the high power–high interest quadrant require the closest engagement, as they possess strong influence over organizational outcomes while also being directly connected to the identified issue (Ackermann & Eden 2011). Although donors and sponsors contribute supplementary financial support, their involvement remains less connected to HopeBox's day-to-day revenue generation and operational engagement cycles. In contrast, corporate B2B partners directly shape HopeBox's revenue stability through procurement decisions, CSR spending behavior, and long-term partnership commitment. HopeBox's management team also holds high strategic influence through program coordination, financial planning, and partnership development (Mitchell et al. 1997). ***Therefore, corporate B2B partners should be prioritized as the key stakeholder group because their engagement behavior most directly influences HopeBox's ability to achieve more stable year-round revenue beyond seasonal festive campaigns.***

5.2 Empathize

As illustrated in the persona profile of Tran Hoang Linh **(Figure 7)**, HopeBox's key stakeholder group consist of corporate B2B partners, CSR and ESG partnership managers are motivated by measurable social impact, employee engagement, and meaningful long-term partnerships. While Linh views HopeBox as a socially meaningful enterprise that supports women's empowerment and aligns with UN SDGs, her engagement with the organization mainly occurs during festive campaigns such as Tet, Mid-Autumn, and Christmas. ***This reveals a gap between the corporate need for continuous ESG engagement and HopeBox's limited non-seasonal partnership opportunities.***



Figure 7: *HopeBox Corporate Partner Persona*

Linh's main challenges include limited year-round engagement touchpoints, inconsistent impact communication, and difficulty justifying repeated CSR spending internally without visible ongoing outcomes. ***Ultimately, corporate partners are not merely seasonal buyers of ethical gifts, but strategic stakeholders seeking continuous, credible, and measurable partnership value throughout the year.***

5.2.1 Empathy Map

As illustrated in **Figure 8**, the empathy map reveals that HopeBox's corporate B2B partners are increasingly driven by ***measurable ESG outcomes, authentic social impact, and long-term partnership value***. Corporate stakeholders seek CSR collaborations that are visible, meaningful, and easy to justify internally to leadership teams. However, HopeBox's engagement activities remain heavily concentrated around festive campaigns such as Tet, Mid-Autumn Festival, and Christmas, limiting continuous interaction throughout the year.

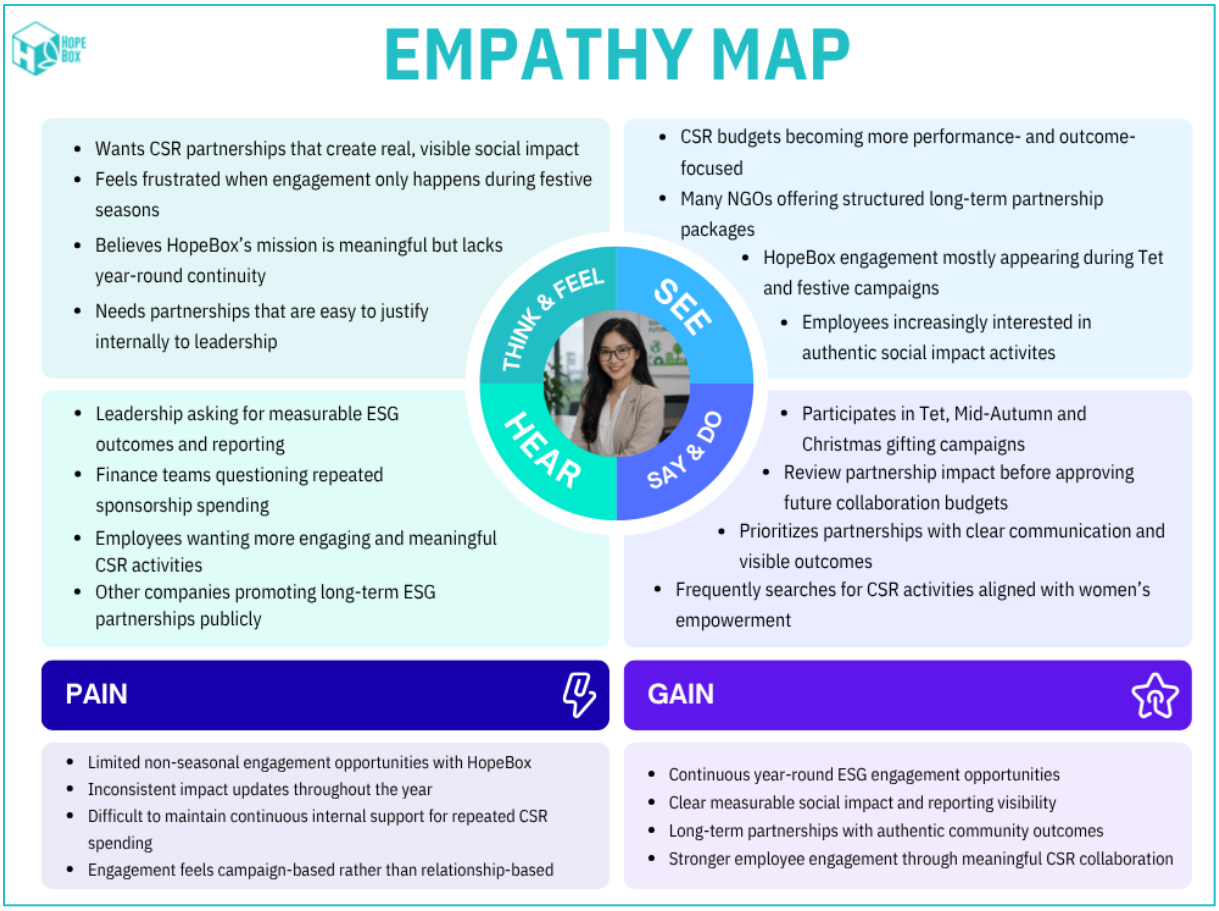


Figure 8: *Corporate Partner Empathy Map (Bland 2012)*

The map also highlights several frustrations experienced by corporate partners. Stakeholders face ***limited non-seasonal engagement opportunities, inconsistent impact communication, and difficulty maintaining ongoing internal support for repeated CSR spending*** without visible year-round outcomes. As a result, engagement becomes campaign-based rather than relationship based, reducing opportunities for sustained long-term collaboration.

At the same time, the empathy map demonstrates that corporate partners are actively seeking clearer impact visibility, stronger engagement continuity, and more authentic ESG partnerships that create mutual long-term value. Therefore, the empathy map reinforces that ***HopeBox's revenue instability is closely linked to the absence of structured non-seasonal corporate engagement mechanisms*** rather than a lack of stakeholder interest in the organization's mission.

5.2.2 Journey Map

The Journey Map in **Figure 9** illustrates the cyclical nature of HopeBox's corporate partner engagement throughout the financial year. During major festive periods such as Tet and year-end campaigns, corporate partners become highly engaged through gifting activities, ESG collaboration proposals, and employee engagement initiatives. However, engagement significantly declines during the mid-year period, where interaction becomes minimal and partnerships lose continuity.

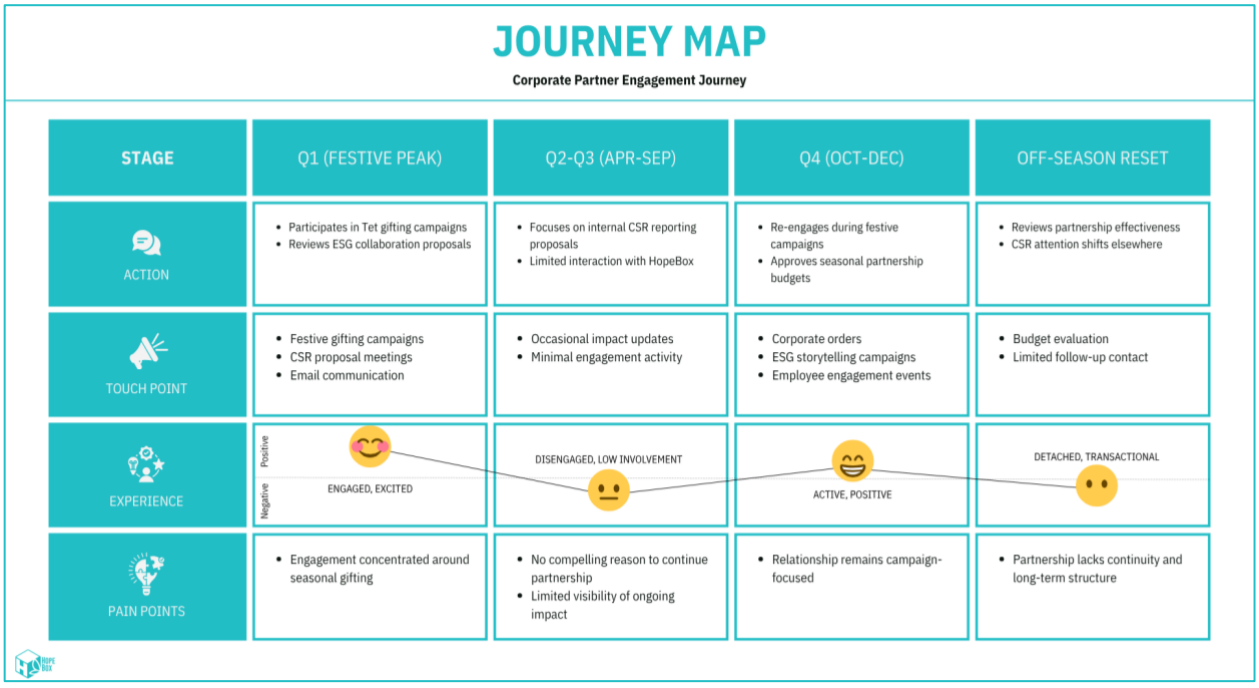


Figure 9: *Corporate Partner Journey Map (Rosenbaum et al. 2017)*

The map reveals that corporate relationships remain heavily campaign-driven rather than strategically sustained. Corporate partners experience limited non-seasonal touchpoints, inconsistent impact visibility, and insufficient reasons to maintain long-term engagement beyond

festive campaigns. Consequently, this recurring engagement cycle creates a transactional partnership structure that weakens year-round revenue stability for HopeBox. ***Therefore, the journey map reinforces that the organization's core challenge is not the lack of corporate interest, but the absence of structured, continuous B2B engagement mechanisms outside seasonal peaks.***

5.3 Define

The Define stage transforms empathy insights into a focused, **human-centered problem statement** that guides meaningful solution development. Instead of treating financial instability as merely an isolated operational challenge, this stage uncovers the underlying human and structural factors contributing to it, identifying those impacted, understanding the reasons behind its persistence, and determining which issues require immediate strategic focus (Liedtka 2018). By grounding problem identification in the real-life experiences of stakeholders, the Define stage guarantees that the solutions address **root causes rather than surface symptoms** (Suhanthi 2024).

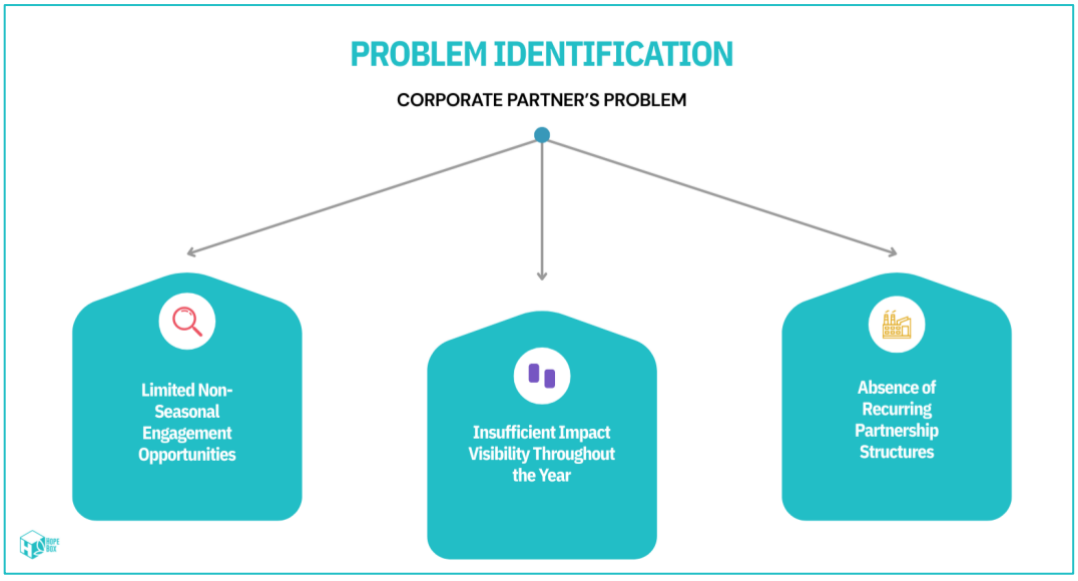


Figure 10: *Corporate Partner's Identified Problems*

5.3.1 Problem Identification

As corporate B2B partners are the stakeholder group most directly connected to HopeBox's seasonal engagement patterns, H1 revenue concentration, and ESG collaboration potential, three interconnected problems emerge that collectively contribute to the organization's revenue instability. These are visualized through mind-mapping to illustrate the layered, systemic nature of each challenge (Alderbashi and Younis 2022).

1. Limited Non-Seasonal Engagement Opportunities

Corporate partners currently engage with HopeBox in concentrated, event-focused intervals, most visibly around International Women's Day in March and the 16 days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence from November to December. Outside of these times, there is a **significant lack of structured opportunities for meaningful collaboration**. From the perspective of corporate partners, this situation is a real source of frustration: Companies with active ESG mandates and CSR commitments are in search of year-round social impact avenues that they can report to their leadership and investors. However, HopeBox currently does not provide a reliable engagement pathway to fulfill this requirement (Cornwell 2019).

The outcome is a misalignment that hurts both sides. Partners want to engage more consistently, but the infrastructure to facilitate that simply does not exist. For HopeBox, this translates directly into a **deeply seasonal revenue curve**, where income spikes briefly before falling into prolonged periods of financial uncertainty.

2. Insufficient Impact Visibility Throughout the Year

Even when corporate partners engage, they rarely receive timely or structured evidence of what their contributions have achieved. In an increasingly accountability-driven CSR landscape, B2B sponsors expect **transparent, ongoing proof of social return on investment** (Scelles et al. 2025). HopeBox's current reporting practices remain largely **informal and episodic**, making it difficult for corporate partners to internally justify continued investment to their own decision-makers.

When partners cannot clearly see or articulate the value of their involvement, renewal becomes uncertain and deeper ESG collaborations remain out of reach (Von Schnurbein et al. 2020).

3. Absence of Recurring Partnership Structures

Most corporate engagements are **project-specific and time-limited**, lacking a structured framework, such as tiered sponsorship packages or annual partnership agreements. That would allow partners to commit to HopeBox over multiple financial cycles. As Sargeant (2013) states, organizations that rely on one-off engagements rather than fostering layered, long-term relationships consistently experience **greater revenue volatility and lower partner retention rates**.

5.3.2 Problem Prioritization

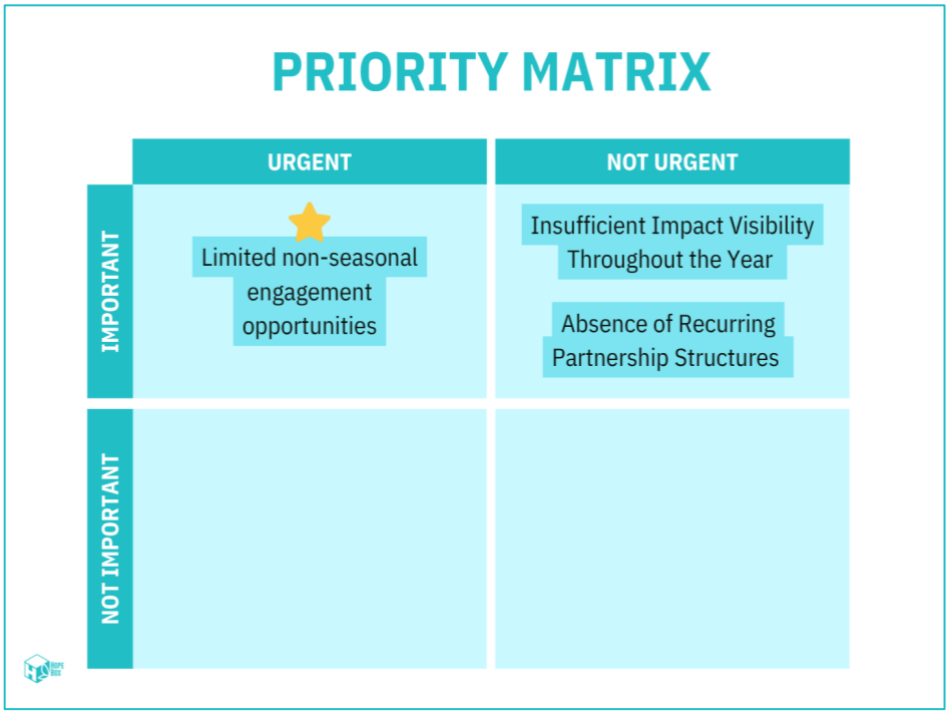


Figure 11: *Prioritize Problems (Cornwell 2019; Tribak 2025)*

As illustrated in Figure 11, limited non-seasonal engagement opportunities are recognized as the most significant issue, positioned within the Important and Urgent quadrant (Cornwell 2019;

Tribak 2025). This situation represents the most direct and actionable lever related to HopeBox's revenue challenge. Corporate partners are already engaged and interested, but the **year-round engagement architecture does not yet exist**. Addressing this gap does not necessitate the creation of entirely new external relationships, rather, it involves the design of appropriate touchpoints to convert existing partner goodwill into a ***steady financial commitment*** (Tribak 2025).

Insufficient impact visibility and the absence of recurring partnership structures both fall in the Important but Not Urgent quadrant. These represent significant structural improvements, but they are most effectively developed on a foundation of active engagement rather than being developed beforehand (Battilana and Lee 2020).

5.3.3 Problem Analysis

The 5 Whys diagram serves as a problem-solving tool that helps identify the root cause of a problem by repeatedly asking "Why?" until the cause is revealed (Croft 2025).

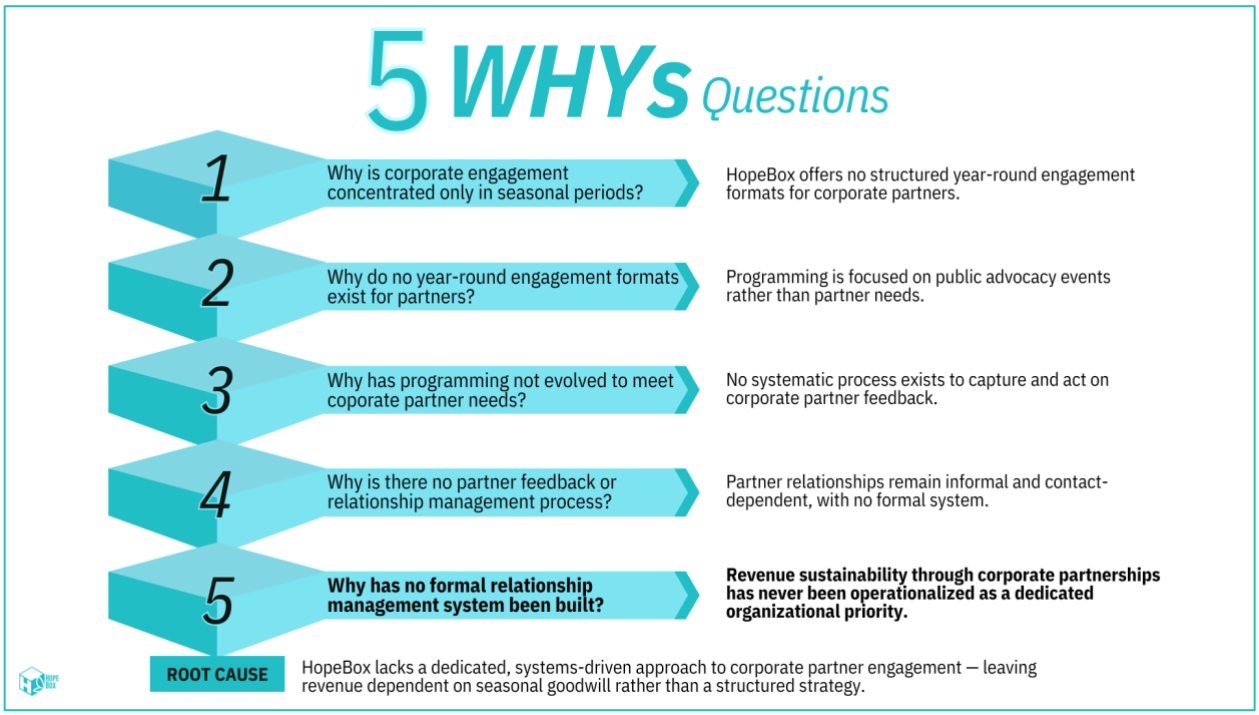


Figure 12: *5 Whys Model (Battilana and Lee 2014)*

A 5 Whys analysis conducted on HopeBox's most significant problem indicates that the **root cause is not a lack of external demand**, corporate partners truly desire to participate in gender equity

and GBV initiatives. The challenge is internal: HopeBox has not yet made revenue sustainability through corporate partnerships a focused organizational priority, resulting in engagement that is reactive and relationship-dependent rather than systematically structured (Battilana and Lee 2014).

PROBLEM STATEMENT: HopeBox faces a significant revenue stability challenge due to the ***lack of structured, non-seasonal engagement opportunities for its corporate B2B partners.*** This issue stems from an ***insufficient year-round partnership infrastructure*** and limited proactive relationship management, resulting in highly seasonal engagement and unstable funding cycles that threaten the organization's long-term operational sustainability. Consequently, HopeBox must develop ***continuous, mission-aligned corporate engagement pathways*** that encourage consistent year-round partnership participation, strengthen financial resilience, and foster deeper long-term social impact collaboration.

III. SOLUTIONS

1. Ideate

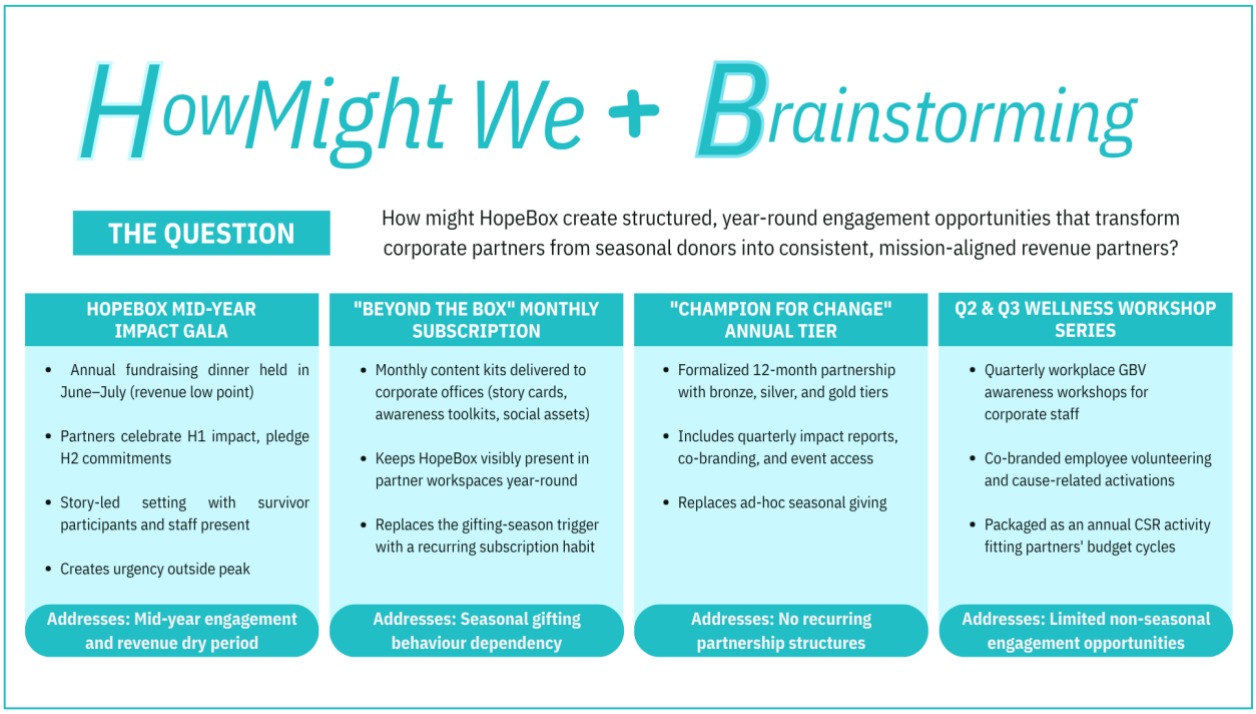


Figure 13: *HMW question – Brainstorming the solution (Lewrick & Palaj 2022)*

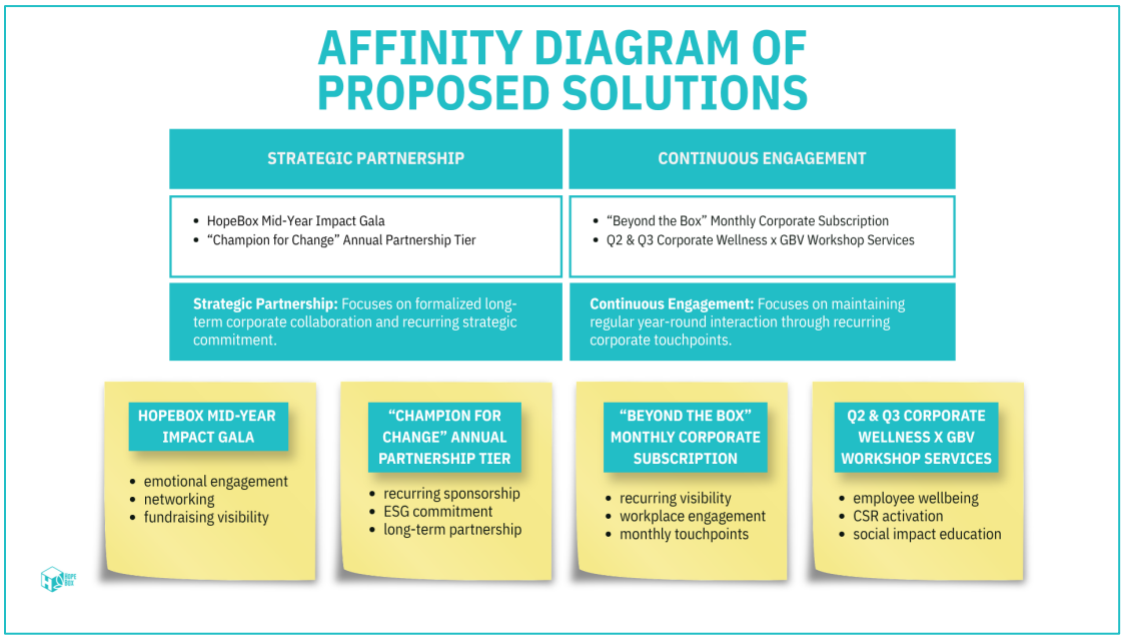


Figure 14: *Affinity Diagram of Proposed Solutions*

In the ideate stage, brainstorming and affinity diagrams are used to generate and organize potential solutions for HopeBox's limited non-seasonal B2B engagement opportunities. Brainstorming was used to encourage divergent thinking and explore creative ideas to develop potential solutions (Keeley et al., 2020), thereby strengthening year-round corporate engagement and improving revenue stability. After generating the ideas, an affinity diagram was applied to categorize the generated ideas into meaningful groups based on their relationships, helping identify patterns and themes (Krause and Pernice 2024).

The brainstorming process produced four main solutions. Firstly, the Q2 & Q3 Corporate Wellness x GBV Workshop Series proposed branded workplace workshops that provide CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility) and employee wellbeing activities outside festive periods. Secondly, the "Beyond the Box" Monthly Corporate Subscription introduced recurring monthly content kits to maintain HopeBox's visibility within corporate workplaces during the year. These two solutions were categorized under Continuous Engagement because both focus on maintaining regular interaction and recurring workplace touchpoints between HopeBox and its corporate partners (corporate customers). This segmentation highlights the need for HopeBox to maintain a consistent presence even outside traditional gift-giving seasons to stay top of mind with customers.

Meanwhile, the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala and the "Champion for Change" Annual Partnership Tier were grouped under Strategic Partnership. The Mid-Year Impact Gala proposed an annual fundraising and networking event designed to foster emotional connection and stronger commitment from corporate partners during the organization's low-revenue period. Similarly, the Annual Partnership Tier introduced a formalized 12-month partnership structure to encourage recurring sponsorship and long-term collaboration. These solutions were categorized under Strategic Partnership because they focus on strengthening deeper corporate commitment and creating more sustainable long-term partnerships. Overall, the affinity diagram revealed that HopeBox's B2B engagement issue is caused not only by limited interaction frequency but also by the ***lack of structured, long-term partnership mechanisms beyond seasonal campaigns***.

This demonstrates that HopeBox's challenge is not solely a seasonal sales issue, but also a ***relationship management issue***. The findings highlight the importance of creating continuous

engagement opportunities that can strengthen long-term corporate commitment and improve partnership sustainability beyond festive campaigns.



Figure 15: *Action Priority Matrix (Lewrick & Palaj 2022)*

Following the affinity diagram analysis, an Action Priority Matrix was used to evaluate the proposed solutions based on implementation effort and strategic impact. This decision-making tool helps identify high-impact solutions with manageable implementation effort, allowing organizations to prioritize quick wins effectively (Lewrick & Palaj 2022; RMIT n.d.). The HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala was identified as the most suitable **"Quick Win" solution** because it offers a strong balance between strategic impact and feasibility.

In terms of impact, the gala directly addresses HopeBox's key challenge of ***limited non-seasonal B2B engagement*** by creating a dedicated mid-year interaction point for corporate partners during the organization's low-revenue period. Unlike traditional campaigns that rely heavily on gift-giving behavior, the gala introduces an emotionally engaging experience that combines fundraising, networking, storytelling and corporate recognition. This can strengthen emotional connection, increase brand visibility and create engagement opportunities to re-engage with HopeBox outside festive periods. This also reflects the importance of relationship-building strategies in nonprofit organizations, where ongoing stakeholder engagement can improve long-

term partnership sustainability. In terms of implementation effort, the gala was considered more feasible than the other proposed solutions because it operates as a single flagship event rather than requiring continuous year-round coordination.

According to MacPherson (2024), 73% of marketers believe events such as galas are more effective than other marketing tactics for customer engagement, while 52% consider events to generate stronger business value than alternative channels. This suggests that event-based engagement strategies can effectively strengthen HopeBox's corporate visibility and stakeholder relationships.

In contrast, the "Champion for Change" Annual Partnership Tier and the "Beyond the Box" Monthly Corporate Subscription were positioned as Major Projects because they require continuous stakeholder management, recurring content development and sustained operational commitment. Meanwhile, the Q2 & Q3 Corporate Wellness x GBV Workshop Series was categorized as a Fill-In due to its reliance on facilitator availability, employee participation and scheduling coordination. ***Therefore, the Mid-Year Impact Gala was prioritized as the most strategically balanced solution because it combines high impact, stakeholder engagement and implementation feasibility while avoiding significant long-term operational demands.***

2. Prototype

2.1 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Storyboard



Figure 16: *HopeBox Mid-Year GALA Storyboard (AI generated)*

The first prototype artefact is an AI-generated storyboard created using ChatGPT (see Appendix for prompt), visualizing the gala experience across five frames: guest arrival, the Impact Wall, storytelling dining, the Champion for Change partnership pitch, and a closing recognition ceremony. This sequence maps the full donor engagement pathway **from cognitive trust to long-term commitment** (Hsiung 2024).

2.2 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Mock-Up Event

A mockup-event was developed for the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala 2026, themed “Running Toward Hope,” to visualize how the gala would function as a corporate ESG networking and fundraising event. The mockup includes formal event invitation, the six-panel corporate partnership brochure, the impact story card, the Journey of HopeBox infographic, and the LinkedIn recognition post.



Figure 17: *HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Mock-Up*

2.2.1 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact GALA Invitation



Figure 18: *HopeBox Mid-Year GALA Invitation*

The second prototype artefact is the invitation for the Annual Mid-Year Impact Gala, held on June 25th, 2026, at Fortuna Hotel, Hanoi (see ***Appendix C*** for evaluation). The gala was designed to address HopeBox's lack of corporate engagement opportunities during the H1 revenue gap by

creating a new **mid-year partnership opportunity outside seasonal campaigns**. The invitation uses HopeBox's teal and cream branding alongside partner logos such as UNIQLO, KOEM Coffee, and Vietnam Airlines to strengthen credibility and social proof (Mitchell, Agle and Wood 1997).

2.2.2 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact GALA Corporate Partnership Brochure



Figure 19: *HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Corporate Partnership Brochure (Front Side)*



Figure 20: *HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Corporate Partnership Brochure (Back Page)*

The third prototype artefact is a six-panel corporate partnership brochure distributed to prospective B2B partners at the gala and through outreach channels. The first three panels establish HopeBox's mission, present key statistics on gender-based violence in Vietnam and outline the six-month transition program. Statistics including 63% of Vietnamese women experiencing violence and 90% not reporting abuse highlight the urgency of HopeBox's mission while providing credible ESG evidence for corporate stakeholders (MOLISA, GSO & UNFPA 2020). The remaining panels introduce the Champion for Change Partnership Program, explaining how recurring corporate sponsorship funds year-round survivor support across counselling, vocational training, and employment transition. By framing partnership as **ongoing ESG collaboration rather than seasonal donation**, the brochure directly addresses HopeBox's problem of limited recurring partnership structures (Sargeant and Shang 2017).

2.2.3 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact GALA Corporate Partnership Infographic



Figure 21: *HopeBox's Journey Infographic*

The fourth prototype artefact is the "Journey of HopeBox" infographic, designed to visually guide stakeholders through the survivor transformation journey from crisis to long-term independence. The infographic presents HopeBox's impact through five stages, helping convert abstract social outcomes into **emotional connection and personal understanding**. This storytelling approach strengthens donor engagement and long-term partnership interest.

2.2.4 HopeBox Story Card

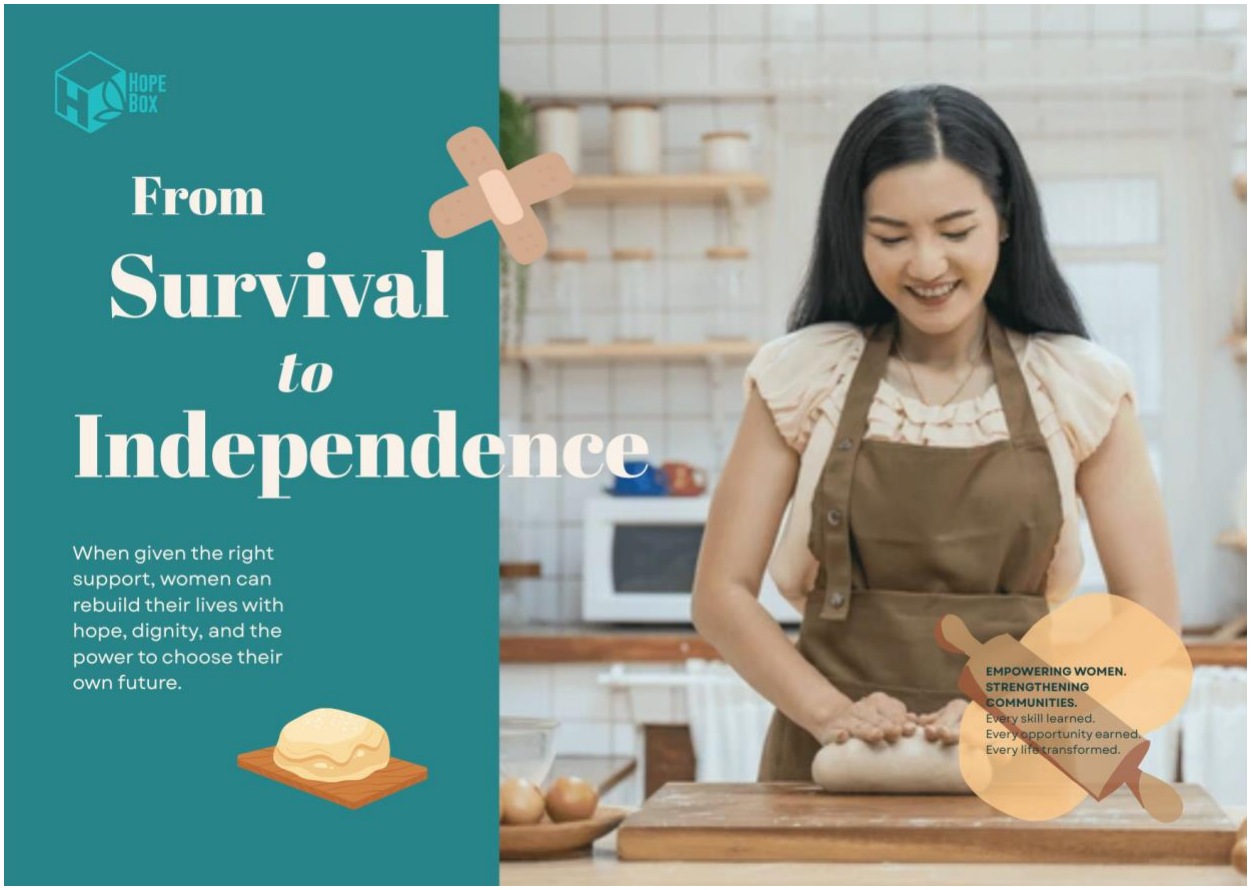


Figure 22: *HopeBox Story Card (Front Page)*

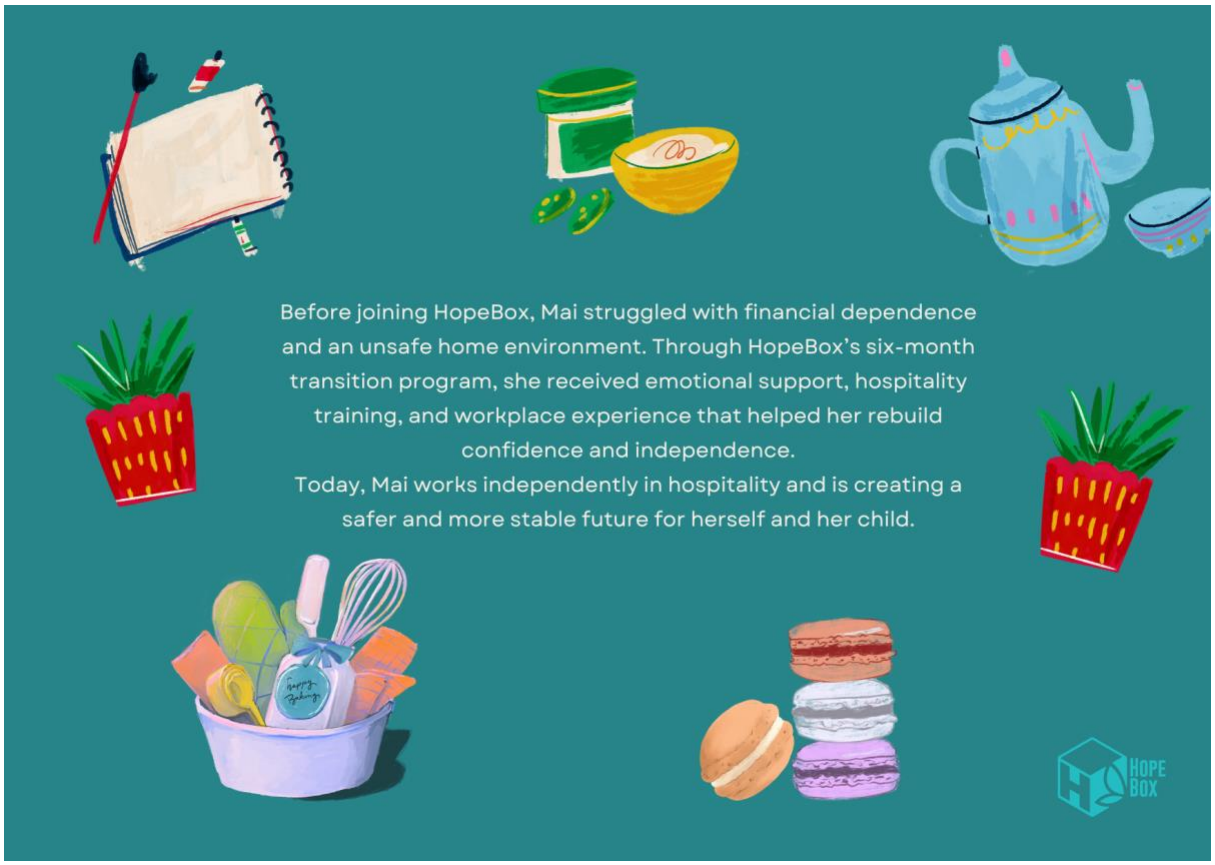


Figure 23: *HopeBox Story Card (Back Page)*

The fifth prototype artefact is a two-sided impact story card featuring a fictional survivor named Mai. The card communicates HopeBox's transition model from crisis to independence through emotional storytelling and hospitality focused imagery. Mai's journey through the six-month program demonstrates how counselling, vocational training, and employment support create long term economic empowerment. This applies the identifiable victim effect, where individual stories create **stronger emotional engagement than statistics alone**.

2.2.5 HopeBox Mid-Year Impact GALA LinkedIn Post

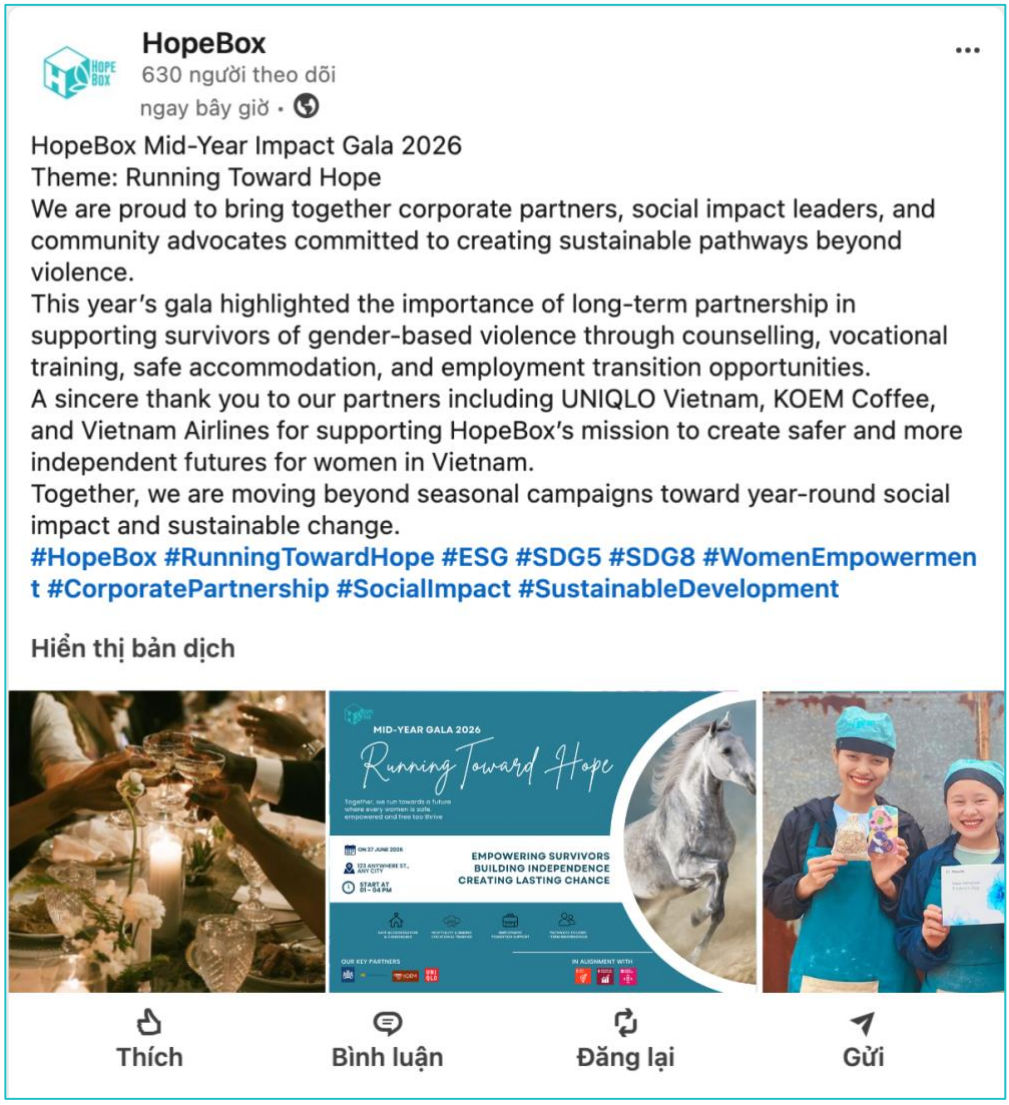


Figure 24: *HopeBox's Mid-Year Impact GALA LinkedIn Post*

The sixth prototype artefact is a LinkedIn recognition post promoting the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala 2026, themed "Running Toward Hope." The prototype demonstrates how HopeBox can maintain corporate engagement after the physical event through digital visibility and public sponsor recognition. The post highlights partnerships with organizations such as UNIQLO Vietnam, KOEM Coffee, and Vietnam Airlines while reinforcing HopeBox's commitment to women's empowerment and sustainable social impact. Public recognition increases ESG visibility and supports long-term B2B relationship building and recurring sponsorship commitment

(Cornwell 2019). Furthermore, post-event digital stewardship helps **transform partner relationships from episodic to enduring** (Scherhag, Eikenboom and Hartmann 2020).

3. Testing Phase

The testing phase for the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala applies Brown's (2008) three design thinking lenses: **desirability, viability, and feasibility** to evaluate whether the event can effectively raise awareness, attract funding, and strengthen corporate stakeholder engagement. The prototype artefacts tested include the AI-generated storyboard, the formal event invitation, the six-panel corporate partnership brochure, the impact story card, the Journey of HopeBox infographic, and the LinkedIn recognition post.

Desirability is measured through audience emotional response, sponsor interest, and participant engagement. Testing focuses on whether the invitation and storyboard create a ***compelling event narrative***, and whether the brochure and story card successfully communicate urgency and social impact to ESG-driven partners. Key metrics include RSVP intention rates, sponsor inquiry numbers, post impressions, and audience feedback on storytelling resonance. Strong responses indicate the gala concept effectively connects with both corporate and community audiences.

Viability evaluates financial sustainability and long-term partnership potential. This includes measuring sponsorship tier uptake, donation pledge conversions, and cost-to-fundraising ratios. For the LinkedIn post, viability is assessed by tracking whether public partner recognition drives new sponsorship inquiries or encourages resharing, extending HopeBox's reach at no additional cost. ***Repeat sponsorship interest remains the key indicator*** of commercial sustainability (Scherhag, Eikenboom and Hartmann 2020).

Feasibility examines HopeBox's operational capacity to deliver the gala successfully, including event logistics, staff coordination, and production requirements. The LinkedIn post requires minimal resources, making it highly feasible as an ongoing engagement tool. By combining measurable performance targets with iterative refinement, this framework enables HopeBox to scale the Mid-Year Impact Gala into a ***sustainable annual fundraising event*** (Cornwell 2019).

IV. CONCLUSION

This report examined HopeBox Vietnam's revenue instability challenge through a Design Thinking approach, focusing on how seasonal corporate engagement affects the organization's financial resilience and long-term social impact. The analysis showed that HopeBox has a strong survivor-centered mission, clear ESG alignment, and meaningful corporate credibility; however, its revenue model remains vulnerable because B2B engagement is concentrated around festive periods such as Tet, Mid-Autumn Festival, and Christmas.

Through stakeholder analysis, persona development, empathy mapping, and journey mapping, corporate B2B partners were identified as the key stakeholder group most directly influencing HopeBox's revenue stability. The findings revealed that corporate partners are not uninterested in HopeBox's mission. Instead, they lack structured reasons to engage beyond seasonal campaigns. The main problems identified were limited non-seasonal engagement opportunities, insufficient year-round impact visibility, and the absence of recurring partnership structures.

The ideation and prioritization process showed that the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala is the most suitable solution because it directly addresses the mid-year engagement gap while remaining feasible as a single flagship event. By combining storytelling, ESG networking, fundraising, corporate recognition, and seasonal purchases into more sustained partnerships.

Overall, the key insight is that HopeBox's revenue challenge is not only a financial issue but also a relationship management issue. Strengthening structured, mission-aligned corporate engagement throughout the year is essential for improving financial resilience, sustaining survivor support programs, and expanding HopeBox's long-term impact.

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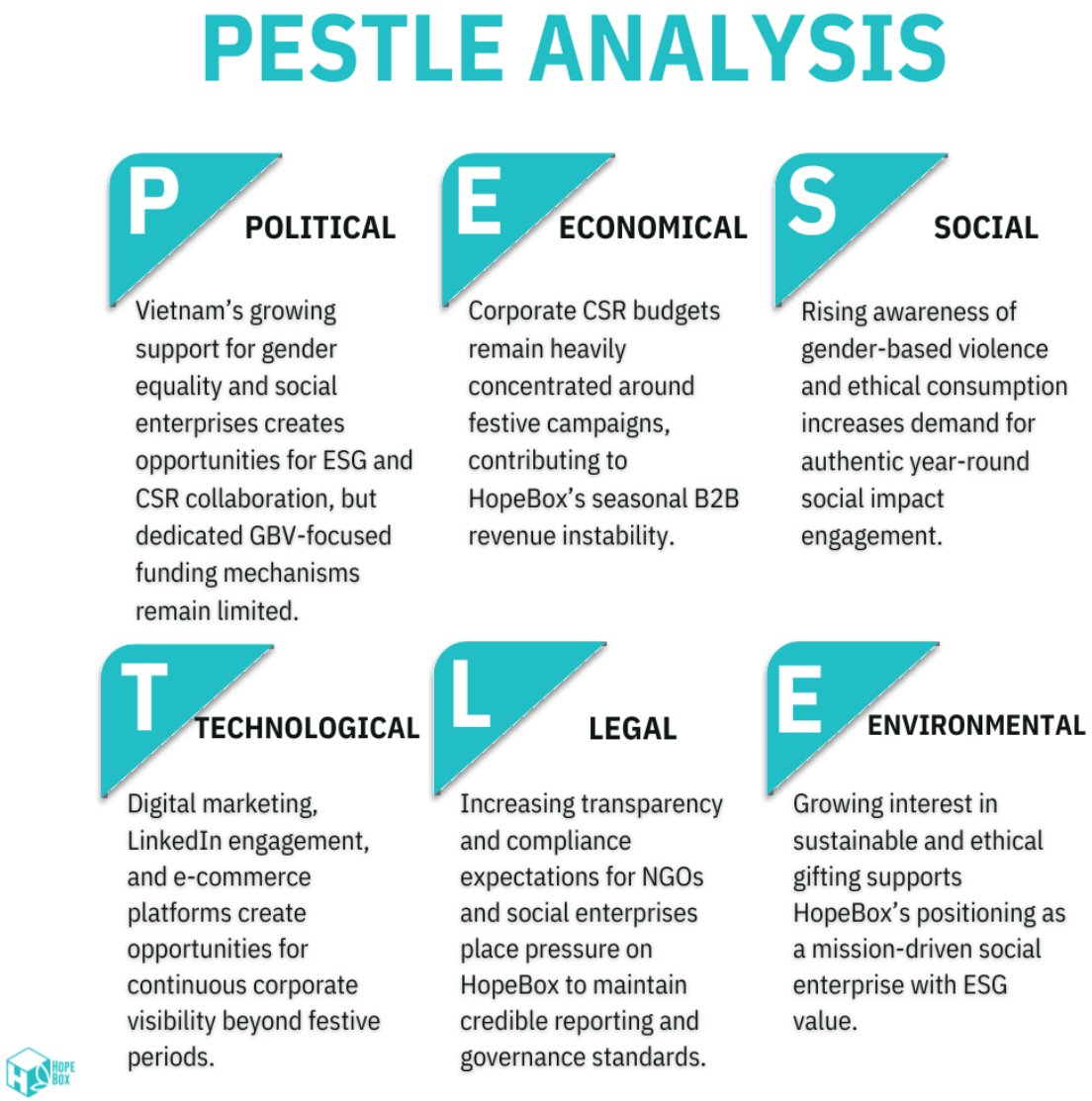
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APPENDICES

Appendix A — PESTLE Analysis



Appendix B — HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala Storyboard AI Prompt

Create a cinematic six-frame storyboard for the "HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala 2026" themed "Running Toward Hope."
The storyboard should visualize the emotional corporate ESG partnership journey from awareness to long-term commitment in a warm, premium, and socially impactful atmosphere.

Visual style:

- realistic editorial storyboard style
- semi-cinematic corporate event photography
- elegant warm lighting
- soft teal, cream, gold, and warm bakery-inspired color palette
- emotionally engaging but professional
- modern ESG fundraising gala aesthetic
- high-end nonprofit networking atmosphere
- subtle Vietnamese cultural elegance
- consistent character continuity across all frames
- clean storyboard panel layout with captions underneath each frame

Frame 1 — Guest Arrival & Registration
Corporate guests and ESG managers arrive at a luxury hotel ballroom in Hanoi. HopeBox branding visible on welcome signage. Guests wearing business formal attire are greeted warmly by staff and survivors. Elegant floral decorations, soft lighting, premium atmosphere, emotional anticipation.

Caption:
"Corporate partners arrive and begin their HopeBox impact journey."

Frame 2 — Impact Wall Experience
Guests stop at a large "Journey of Hope" impact wall displaying survivor stories, statistics about gender-based violence in Vietnam, photos of vocational training, and ESG partnership achievements. Some guests look emotional and reflective while reading the stories.

Caption:
"Guests connect emotionally with HopeBox's social mission and impact."

Frame 3 — Storytelling Dining Experience
Inside the gala ballroom, guests enjoy elegant dining while a HopeBox representative speaks on stage about survivor empowerment and long-term partnership impact. Large projector screens display visuals of women receiving training, healing, and employment support.

Caption:
"Storytelling transforms corporate engagement into emotional investment."

Frame 4 — Champion for Change Partnership Pitch
HopeBox management presents the "Champion for Change" partnership program to corporate representatives. ESG managers discuss sponsorship brochures and partnership packages at tables. Atmosphere feels strategic, collaborative, and optimistic.

Caption:
"Corporate partners explore long-term ESG collaboration opportunities."

Frame 5 — Recognition & Networking Ceremony
Corporate sponsors are publicly recognized on stage and on digital screens. Executives, NGO leaders, and survivors network together, shaking hands and taking photos. Warm celebratory atmosphere emphasizing partnership and shared impact.

Caption:
"Recognition strengthens trust, visibility, and long-term commitment."

Frame 6 — Post-Event Digital Engagement
LinkedIn-style social media post shown on a smartphone and laptop screen featuring gala photos, sponsor logos, and HopeBox appreciation messages. Corporate employees react positively online with comments and engagement.

Caption:
"Digital visibility extends partnership engagement beyond the physical event."

Additional details:

- include subtle HopeBox branding throughout
- include Vietnamese women survivors respectfully and empowering, not victimized
- atmosphere should feel hopeful, empowering, elegant, and authentic
- realistic human emotions and interactions
- high-detail cinematic composition
- professional nonprofit fundraising aesthetic
- no cartoon style
- ultra realistic, high quality, cohesive storytelling flow

Appendix C — Fortuna Hotel Hanoi Venue Review and Location Evaluation

Fortuna Hotel Hanoi was selected as the proposed venue for the HopeBox Mid-Year Impact Gala 2026 due to its professional event facilities, suitable corporate atmosphere, and positive service reputation. Estimated event costs range from approximately 80,000,000 to 150,000,000 VND depending on venue rental, catering, decoration, and technical setup. The hotel currently holds an overall rating of 4.0/5, with strong scores in service and cleanliness. Visitor reviews frequently highlighted the hotel's good staff service, food quality, and event suitability, while recommending Grab as a more convenient and effective transportation option for guests attending the gala.

